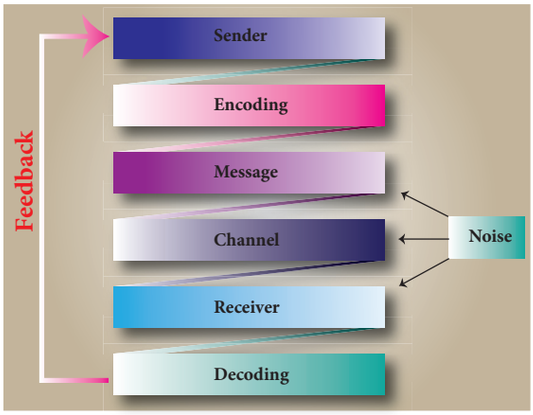


- **Channels** are means of conveying and receiving message through visual, auditory and tactile senses.
- **Feedback** is the message the receiver returns. It indicates whether the receiver understand the meaning of the sender's message.

4.5 Essentials of Good Communication

Listen

Always start by emptying out all your pre-conceptions of what you know. Have an open mind about what the other party has to say.

Do not interrupt

Allow the other party to fully express their concerns. Suppress any urge to cut in with your own.

Avoid pointing fingers

Placing blame always comes across as an excuse and will quickly alienate the other party.

Be clear and concise

Beating about the bush or sticking to generalize can confuse those you are interacting with. Be as specific as you can and leave no room for doubt.

Repeat the other person's views

Always repeat what the other party has expressed to ensure you fully understand their point of view.

Provide feedback

Without interrupting the speaker, inject some neutral statements, such as "oh," or "I see" to show that they have your undivided attention and that you follow their train of thought.

Show empathy

Empathy is the ability to understand the emotion behind the other party's arguments, especially when the topic is a sensitive one.

Pay attention to non-verbal signs

The body language of the other party will give you important additional information about what they are expressing. Sometimes these cues may even reveal a more truthful view of the situation.

4.5.1 Communication Skills for Nurses

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For a nurse, the ability to communicate is a very important skill and a vital part of the job. Nurses speak to people of varying educational, cultural and social backgrounds and must do so in an effective, caring and professional manner, especially when communicating with patients and their family.

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